- `sum{x ∈ A | x > 0}` is the sum of positive elements of `A`
- `A[i] ← i^3 ("i ϵ {0..|A|-1} | i % 3 ==0)` sets all elements of `A` whose indices are multiples of 3 to the cube of the index.

It goes without saying that, depending on the programming language you choose, there might not be a direct translation into a single instruction, and you will need to use or write a helper method to perform the same operations.

## A.3 Conditional Instructions

The next fundamental concepts we need in order to write a meaningful program are conditional statements. Most programming languages implement conditionals with an if-then-else instruction, and we will use a similar syntax.

For instance, to express a simple algorithm to compute the absolute value of a number (see figure A.1) we will use the following syntax (assuming our input is stored in the variable `x`)